

Doubleheader At Dudley

George Landreth and possibly Sam Cox have been tabbed starters for the University of Texas at El Paso baseball duel Friday against Hardin-Simmons University.

The doubleheader begins at 1 p.m. at Dudley Field and the only comparison between the two squads is the fact that they've both defeated Texas Tech.

Two weeks ago, U.T. El Paso took two of three contests from the Red Raiders and last weekend, Hardin-Simmons split a pair.

Landreth, a big lefty from Midland, Tex., is slated to hurl for the Miners in the opener while Cox, a steadily improving local boy from Riverside could see action in the nightcap.

Landreth's first mound appearance two weeks ago was short-lived when a Texas Tech single bounced off his leg, making for a quick exit for the 200-pound junior.

While the Miners continue to engage in non-Western Athletic Conference action until April 4 against Arizona, the athletic directors have been busy adopting a new playoff system which will allow two conference schools to participate in the NCAA district playoffs.

Under recently approved rules by

the National Collegiate Athletic Association, a conference may send two representatives to district baseball tournaments. They had been limited to the league champion in the past.

The WAC officials said the northern and southern division champions would meet in a best-of-three series for the conference title, beginning May 15 at the southern division school.

On the same date, the runner-up teams of the two divisions would meet in a similar series at the southern division schools. On May 19, a day-night doubleheader will be held between the loser of the WAC title and the winner of the runner-up tourney. If a third game is needed, it would be played the next night.

The victor of that series, along with the league champion, would represent the conference in the district playoffs.

"I think it's a good rule," said Miner coach Andy Cohen, "because more teams will be able to participate in post-season play. Maybe we'll be lucky to finish up there."

But as Cohen knows, the Miners will have to contend with both Arizona and Arizona State, two teams which have dominated the southern division of the WAC for years.